

Day 5 — Primary Source Reading + Mid-Module Check

Module: Pañcabhūta (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students read SB 3.26.36 in IAST with word-by-word gloss and submit the formative quiz.

Materials

- Printed handout: SB 3.26.36 in Devanāgarī, IAST, word-by-word gloss, continuous translation
- Formative quiz (quizzes/formative.md Part B)

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Hand out the printed verse. Quick recall: yesterday's Greek comparison.

Reading (15 min)

- First read — sound.** Teacher reads the IAST aloud once. Students listen.

*mṛdutvaṃ kaṭhinatvaṃ ca śaityam uṣṇatvam eva ca etat sparśasya sparśatvaṃ
tanmātratvaṃ nabhasvataḥ*

- Second read — meaning.** Students follow the word-by-word gloss:

Sanskrit	Gloss
mṛdutvam	softness (nominative neuter)
kaṭhinatvam	hardness
ca	and
śaityam	cold
uṣṇatvam	heat
eva ca	as well
etat	these
sparśasya	of touch (genitive)
sparśatvam	the touch-ness (= the defining quality of touch)
tanmātratvam	the subtle-essence-ness
nabhasvataḥ	of air / wind (genitive; nabhasvat = wind)

Continuous translation: > “Softness, hardness, cold and heat — these are the touch-ness of touch, the subtle essence of air.”

3. Class discussion (8 min):

- What surprises you about the categories included under “touch”?
- Note the philosophical move: *sparsāsya sparśatvam* (touch-ness of touch) — the verse identifies the defining property of a category by giving its essence a name.
- How is this different from a modern dictionary definition of “touch”?

Formative quiz (15 min)

- quizzes/formative.md Part B.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Preview Day 6: “*Tomorrow — the modern lens. What modern science adds, and what it explicitly drops.*”

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Write a 1-paragraph response to “what is gained when philosophy gives an *essence* a name?”
- **Tier down:** Focus on the meaning. The IAST pronunciation is bonus.

Teacher notes

- Don’t require pronunciation perfection. The win is *engagement with the meaning at primary-source level*.
- This is many students’ first time reading a Sanskrit verse. Honour the moment.

Citation(s) used

- SB 3.26.36 — vidya-karana RAG cache day-03-qualities.json#chunks[3]